Statement of Purpose

Yale Outdoors serves the Yale community with high-quality and safe trips to explore the outdoors and develop wilderness skills. Yale Outdoors creates a community for students to meet and learn from others who are interested in the outdoors. Yale Outdoors provides affordable wilderness skills training sessions and outdoors equipment for the Yale community. Above all, Yale Outdoors spreads the love for the outdoors and appreciation for nature with the rest of the Yale community.

History

Outdoor clubs at Yale have a rich history dating back to the 1930s, when an informal "Outing Club" explored Connecticut's wilderness and trails. In 1936, a new club emerged: the Yale Mountaineering Club. Known for their climbing-themed antics (including scaling Harkness tower), the Yale Mountaineering Club entered its golden age after the war in 1947, when a strong corps of leaders embarked on a series of first ascents across the state and North America. Many records and landmarks are still named after the Yale Mountaineering Club..

Notable Mountaineering Club-sponsored expeditions from this era include exploration of the Front Range of Northern Colorado, exploration of the Brooks Range in the North Slope of Alaska, a pioneering ascent of Mount Wood (15,886 ft.) in the St. Elias Mountains of Alaska and the Yukon, and, perhaps most notably, one of the first documented expeditions into the Logan Mountains, a mountain range that demarcates the border between the Yukon and the Northwest Territories and arguably one of the most remote and isolated regions in North America. This latter expedition produced a seminal glaciological survey of the area, collaborated Yale's geology department to collect field samples to analyze the geological origins of the area, and, of course, being mountaineers, logged nine first ascents of 9,000-10,000 foot glaciated peaks and granite spires in the range. More locally, the Mountaineering Club catalogued the eighty plus routes on Sleeping Giant just adjacent to New Haven and, in 1973, published A Climber's Guide to Ragged Mountain in Southington, Connecticut. Since the '70s, however, the club's ambitions became more restrained and it was eventually renamed the Yale Climbing Club.

In the 1990s, the three registered outing clubs at Yale - Yale Mountaineering Club, Yale Outdoors, and Forestry Outing Club - began reaching out to students of all levels and abilities and engaging them with the great outdoors. In the spring of 2009, Yale Outdoors was reorganized into an umbrella organization in an effort to consolidate outdoor life at Yale and combine resources so as to most effectively provide outdoor experiences for the Yale Community. Today, Yale Outdoors serves all members of the Yale Community and beyond, engaging in outdoor service, leading expeditions, and offering skill sessions.

Board Positions: Roles and Responsibilities

Co-Coordinators (*aka Co-Presidents*) (2)

- Year-long position
    - Staggered with one new Co-Coordinator being elected each semester.
- Enacts their general vision for the organization, as supported by the Board
- Oversees all events in the club, keeping board members accountable to their positions and providing support where and when needed
- Maintain smooth operation of all organizational functions
- Organizes bi-weekly board meetings and keeps meeting agendas
- Manages Google Drive and YO email: yaleoutdoors@gmail.com
- Complete annual student organization re-registration during the summer
- Initiate and run Board elections
- Plans semesterly board retreat
- Delegate tasks that are not explicitly listed in this constitution
- Conduct quarterly (mid-semester and end of semester) membership status evaluation
    - Mid-Semester: This should be a quick evaluation. It is to reinstate active Leader membership to those who have previously lost it but have met the requirements by the next mid-semester evaluation. See "Membership > Leaders > Requirements" below.
    - End of Semester: By the end of the semester, all Leaders who have not met the requirements lose their active leadership status and benefits.
- *During Transition*: Ensures all newly elected positions (including co-co) have a smooth and fully prepared transition

Treasurer (2)

- Year-long position
- Manages YO's bank account: Currently under Bank of America
- Manages fund transfer under Venmo and Zelle (enrolled through Bank of America account)
- Responsible for applying, submitting, and depositing all UOFC grants in a timely manner
- Responsible for retaining receipts of all expenses to submit for UOFC reconciliation
- Sets and approves budgets for all club functions (i.e. Break Trips, Kayaking, etc)
- Reimburses members for group expenses.
- Work with leaders to coordinate ongoing financial matters (financial aid, etc)
- *During Transition*: Teach how to apply for UOFC, transfer all bank account information, open a Bank of America Debit card for new treasurers, turn in personal club business card for disposal

Expedition Coordinator (2)

- Year-long position
- Works closely with Weekend Coordinators to make sure all trips to ensure trips are safe and logistically sound.
- Take initiative to take trip ideas and make them happen.
- Focuses on large scale trips (usually outside the state) such as our Fall, Winter, and Spring Break backpacking trips. This includes encouraging interest in leading, overseeing the formation of

trips, and ensuring safety and logistical soundness. These are our biggest trips and are often to National Parks.
- Is in communication with all leaders and the Publicist to ensure the weekly newsletter goes out on time, with the correct information.
- Field-specific "how to run my trip" questions from trip leaders.
- Gets Leaders stoked through presenting trip ideas and maintaining the Trip Bible!

Weekend Coordinator (2)
- Year-long position
- Works closely with Expedition Coordinators and shares responsibility in making sure trips are safe and logistically sound.
- Take initiative to take trip ideas and make them happen.
- Focuses on more local trips, such as day hikes, kayaking, visits to the farm, etc. The Weekend Coordinator is a core pillar in creating consistent events throughout the year.
- Is in communication with the Publicist to ensure the weekly newsletter goes out on time, with the correct information.

Gear Room Manager (1)
- Year-long position
- Manages the YO Gear Room (our treasure trove of equipment for all things outdoor)
    - Maintain gear room cleanliness
- Maintains an updated list of available gear and rental costs (check in with treasurers)
- Oversee gear return, including confirming returned gear is dry and functional and updating the YO inventory document.
- Documents and ensures rented gear is paid for including rate payments and refundable safety deposits are returned.
- Conducts research and outreach to local partners to expand the gear room equipment
    - All purchases must be approved by the treasurers
- Spearheads the YO merch and Schwag (i.e. stickers, flasks, and t-shirts)
- *During Transition*:

Pnucklemaster (1-2)
- Year-long position
- Is in charge of recruiting and training our future: the *Pnuckles!* (yes, spelled with a "P")
- This includes introducing them to the YO leader community in a positive way, coordinating our extracurricular fair presence (Bulldog Days in April and Student Activities Fair in September), and taking charge of the new leader application process.
- Also run the semesterly Pnuckle Orientation and Initiation
- Tracks all Pnuckle process, making sure all Pnuckles are on track to completing requirements
- *During Transition*: Nothing specific. Make sure the next Pnucklemaster knows how the process works.

Publicist (1)
- Year-long position

- Maintains our Yale Connect website, making sure all pages are updated and all links are functional
- Sends out weekly Newsletter containing future trips, sign up links, announcements, and relevant community events
- Responsible for maintaining our social media platform (Instagram)
- Change password upon obtaining accounts for security reasons. Ensure these changes are documented.
- *During Transition*: Transfer all social media accounts and teach how to use Mailchimp. Log out of relevant accounts.

Social Chairs (1)

- Year-long position
- Organizes a minimum of two YOHOs for YO leaders, and one mixer with other crunchy student organizations: planning and publicizing as well as purchasing food and setting up beforehand!
- Organizes social events for the wider Yale community and Yale Outdoors members
- Work with Weekend Coordinator and Board to plan non-outdoors events
- Reach out to Harvard and plan Harvard-Yale crunchyfest

Co-Coordinator Emeriti

- Both Co-cos from the previous year are automatically placed into this position
- Unlike the rest of the Board, the Co-Coordinator Emeriti is not expected to attend all Board Meetings and Leaders' Weekly Meetings. However, they remain on the Board panelist to provide advice. Primary responsibility that the Co-Coordinator Emeritus is accountable for is managing institutional knowledge.
- Additionally responsible for the job of alumni coordinating: making sure all graduating leaders submit post-graduation emails to a centralized document, coordinating fundraising drives among the alumni

Clause 1: Insufficient Board Members

In the case of a small Board, prioritize having at least one of each position. Co-Coordinators must still have 2 people.

Clause 2: Reviving Dissolved Positions

The new constitution (updated November 2025) dissolves and adds a few positions. The following is a list of dissolved positions. If future interests and numbers allow, an amendment and emergency/regular election (depending on time of year) may revive these Board positions. See description in Old Constitution (in Google Drive). There are as listed:

- Wilderness Education Chair
- Outreach and Community Service Chair
- Events Chair

Membership

At Yale Outdoor, we offer a space for people of all commitment levels to participate. The following is a list of membership status, requirements, and benefits.		
Membership Level	Requirements	Benefits

Member	General Members are those who subscribe to the YO mailing list.	Members are welcomed to apply/attend all YO trips.
Pnuckle	Pnuckling is the *process* of a member becoming a leader. This process is only open to undergrads. All members interested in Pnuckling must apply at the beginning of any semester. Pnuckles are expected to fully engage in the Pnuckle programming. The requirements are: ● Attend Pnuckle orientation and initiation ● Co-lead 1 trip/event with Leaders ● Attend at least 3 YO trips/events ● Attend 2 monthly club-wide meetings ● Attend Pnuckle bonding activities led by Pnucklemaster	Pnuckles get priority over members and non-members on trips.
Leader	Leaders are those who have successfully completed a semester of pnuckling. Leadership status lasts until the end of each academic year (even for Fall pnuckles). In order to maintain an active Leader status, Leaders must complete these requirements each semester: ● Lead at least 2 trips/events ● Attend 2 monthly club-wide meetings ● Attend 2 bi-weekly board meetings Co-cos will conduct 2 leadership evaluations each semester. At the end of each semester, those who have not satisfied the requirements above lose their active Leader status. Leaders who lose active status may regain status in the following semester if they complete the requirements before the mid-semester evaluation.	● Get funding (via treasurers) to make trip proposals into real trip ● Leaders' retreat ● Gear rental discount ● Voting rights (for Board and amendment changes)
Board Member	Only leaders can become Board Members. The Board is elected by all voting-eligible Leaders (meaning Leaders who have active status. See above). Board members are expected to: ● Carry out their roles to the best of their ability ● Attend bi-weekly Board meetings ● Attend and lead monthly members meeting ● Engage in club activities	● Get funding (via treasurers) to make trip proposals into real trip ● Leader retreat ● Board retreat ● Gear rental discount ● Voting rights (for Board and amendment changes)

Elections

Eligibility

- All active Leaders may run for board positions (see active status in "Memberships")
- Co-Coordinators must have at least 1 year of experience on Board

Timeline and Process

Towards End of Fall Semester	Co-Coordinators must set an election date. The election must happen before the second Saturday of December. This will ensure there is adequate time for transitions.
2 Weeks Before Elections	Co-Coordinators must send an email to all eligible Leaders announcing the election. Leaders have one week to fill out an interest form.
1 Week Before Elections	Co-Coordinators close the applications. They compile all candidates into one document and send it to all voting eligible Leaders.
Day of Election	Co-Coordinators must mediate the elections. At this point, everyone should know who is running for which position. The Co-cos will go down the list of candidates. Candidates may give a short speech. If necessary, the Leaders may ask the candidate to leave the room for a short discussion. Voting happens through anonymous voting slips. TO WIN: The person who gets the highest number of votes (does not have to be 50% +1) wins the election.
Within 2 Weeks After Elections	Co-Coordinators must make sure that all incumbent and incoming Board members meet and feel confident about their transition.

Clause 1: Co-Coordinator Elections
The role of Co-Coordinator is a staggered two person position in which one person is elected in the fall and one in the spring, each serving a one year term. Fall Co-Coordinator elections will happen along with officer elections, and spring elections will happen by the second Saturday of April following the same protocol. If the Co-Coordinator selected in the spring is a current officer, Co-Coordinators will follow the procedure outlined in Clause 2.

Clause 2: Mid-Year Vacancy
In the event that a position becomes vacant at the end of the spring term, the Co-Coordinators must hold an emergency election to fill that position. The emergency election must happen within 4 weeks of the vacancy and follows the guidelines of a regular election (see above). During the time between the vacancy and the new appointment, the Co-cos can assume the roles or appoint an interim role. The interim role is dissolved upon a new elected Board member.

Changing the Constitution

Amendment Process

The world is an ever changing place, and YO must change to meet these demands. As such, the YO constitution may be changed through an amendment. It should follow this process:

1. Leaders and Board members may submit an amendment to the Board via the Co-Coordinators.
2. Co-Coordinators will review and present the proposal to the Board within 2 weeks of the proposal being made.
3. The Board will vote whether or not to move the proposal for a full vote. A pass requires a simple majority (50% +1) of the Board.
    a. A quorum is the entire board.
    b. Passing the Board does not mean the proposal becomes an amendment. It means it goes to the floor (Leaders) for a full vote.
    c. If the Board rejects the proposal, the proposal dies. The proposal can be resubmitted if desired.
4. If the Board passes the proposal, then the Co-cos must add it to the docket. This is a running list of all pending proposals. The vote on amendments will happen at the next election in which a Board position is being voted on (whether it's an emergency election or regular Spring Board election). The proposals will appear on the same document as candidates (see Elections) and sent to Leaders.
5. Only voting eligible Leaders and Board may vote. 60% of voting eligible people attending the election is enough to pass the proposal.
    a. There are no quorum requirements. The 60% is out of all voting eligible people at the election meeting.
    b. If the Leaders reject the proposal, the proposal dies. The proposal can be resubmitted if desired.
6. If the proposal passes, the proposal becomes an amendment.
7. Within a week of the proposal passing the full vote, the Co-coordinators must document the Amendment at the bottom of the Constitution and change relevant sections. You should directly edit the constitution, but be very detailed in the Amendment section; document what it was before and what it was changed to. This way, future leaders may see the changes.

Approved Constitution Amendments:

Amendment 1: (Be as detailed as possible)
Proposal Date:
Approval Date: